

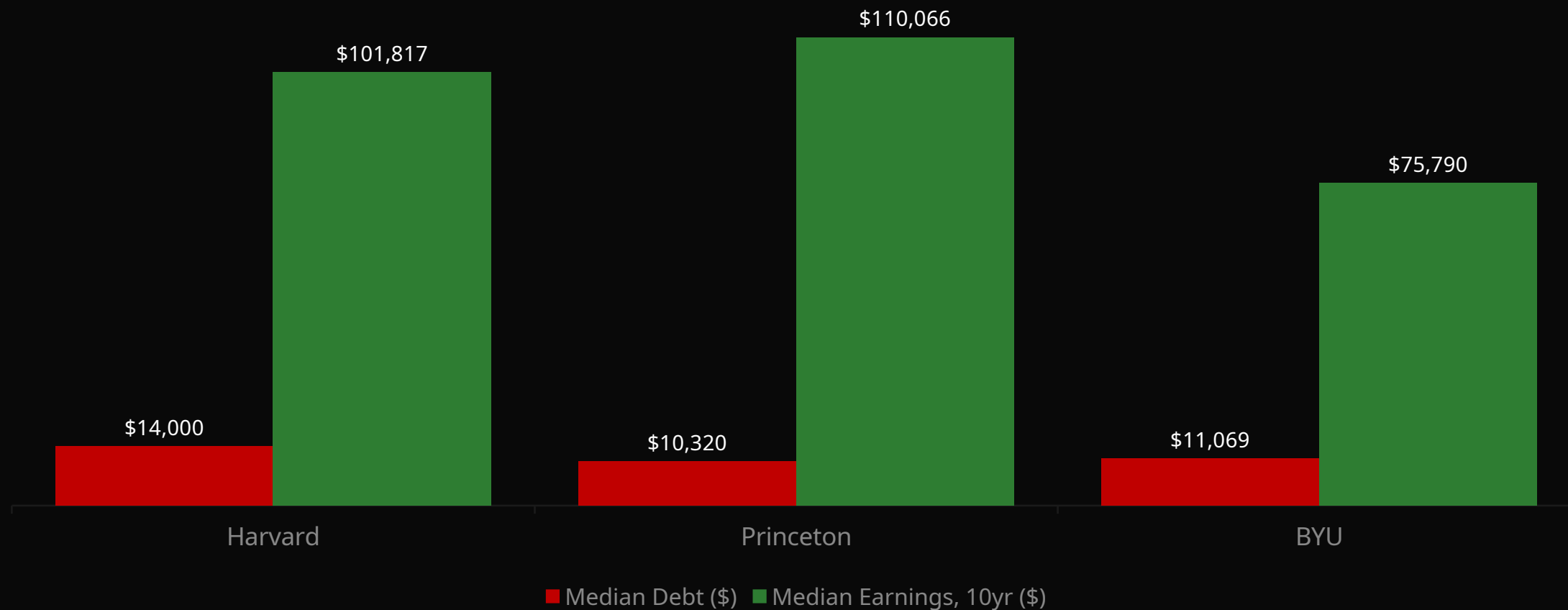
COLLEGE ROI · HARVARD · PRINCETON · BYU

It's Not About Cost. It's About **PAYOFF.**

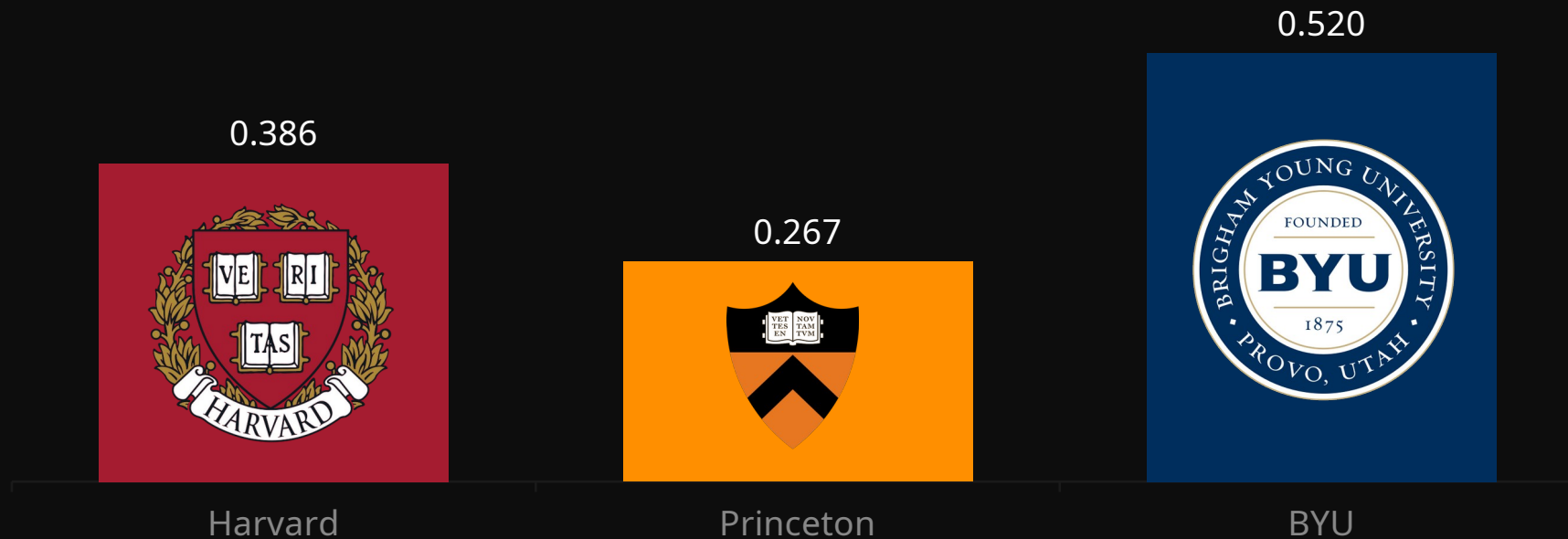
A degree is only worth it if the earnings it buys outrun the debt it costs. Here's how three very different schools stack up — and which one wins.

THE RAW NUMBERS

Debt and Earnings Look Nothing Alike Across These Three Schools



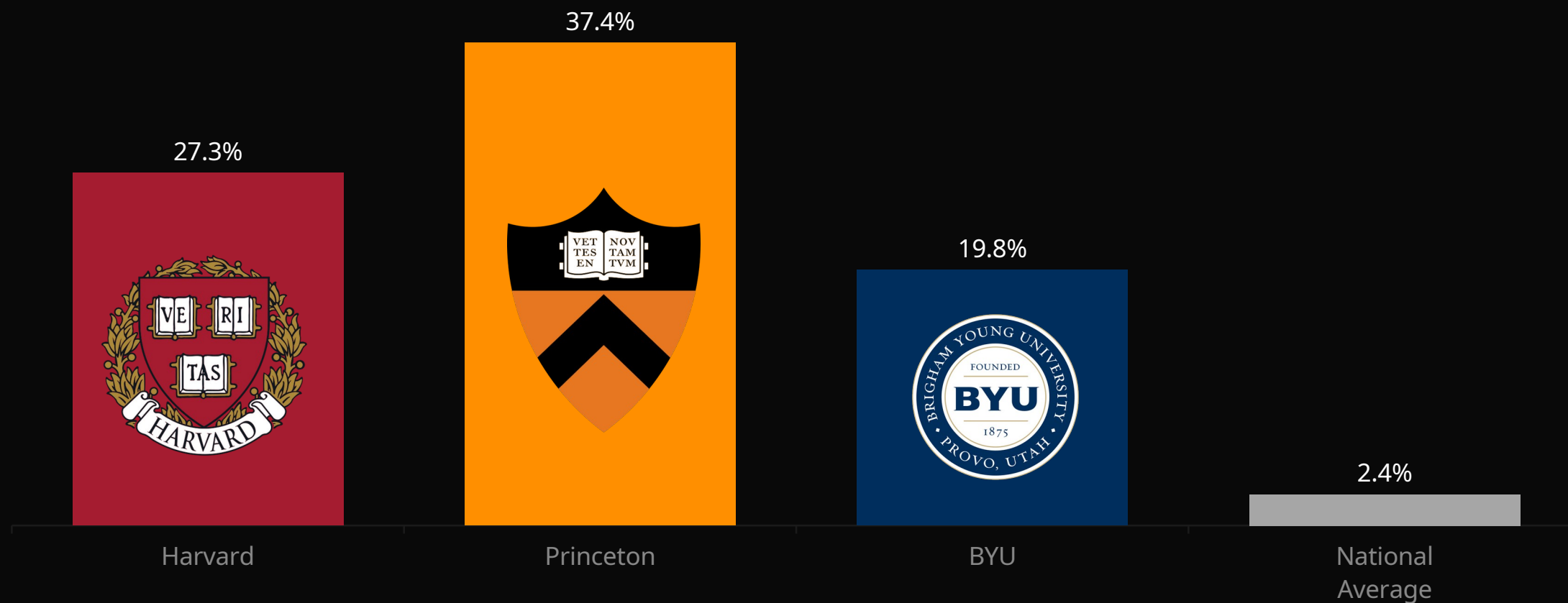
Princeton Returns 27¢ of Debt for Every Dollar of Wage Premium



Lower is better — less debt per dollar of wage boost a degree earns in that state.

AGAINST THE NATIONAL PICTURE

All Three Out-Earn the Typical Bachelor's Degree by 20–37%



THE REALITY CHECK

For a Typical School, the Premium Is Only 2.4%

2.4%

average earnings premium
at a typical U.S. school

27.3%

Harvard

37.4%

Princeton

19.8%

BYU

These three clear the bar by a mile. Most schools barely clear it at all — if one on your list doesn't, walking away is a legitimate choice, not a failure.

DO THIS FOR YOUR OWN LIST

Run the Same Math on Every School You're Considering



Debt-to-Premium Ratio

Median debt ÷ that state's college wage premium. Lower means less debt per dollar of earnings boost.



Real Earnings vs. Baseline

A school's median earnings minus the state's average bachelor's-holder earnings. Higher means grads outperform the typical degree.

Pick the school with the best ratio — or walk away if none of them clear it.